

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 591

By Harris

A RESOLUTION to honor the University of Memphis Tigers football team on an outstanding season.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those student athletes who represent this State with the greatest ability on the gridiron; and

WHEREAS, led by Coach Ryan Silverfield, the University of Memphis (UM) Tigers posted the first successive double-digit win seasons in program history, and with eleven wins in 2024, marked just the second season with eleven or more victories; and

WHEREAS, with eleven wins, the UM Tigers compiled a record of 21-5 overall in the past two seasons, the most wins in two years in Memphis's history; and

WHEREAS, the Tigers closed out the 2024 season ranked number twenty-three in the Coaches Poll and number twenty-four in the AP Poll, a feat that marks the Tigers' first appearance in either poll since 2019; the team was ranked or received votes in the AP Poll for ten weeks and the Coaches Poll for fourteen weeks during the 2024 season; and

WHEREAS, UM currently holds the longest active streak in the nation of scoring twenty or more points in forty consecutive games, dating back to a 33-28 victory over Tulane University on November 27, 2021; and

WHEREAS, their 20-12 win over Florida State marked UM's first win over a power conference opponent on the road since defeating the University of Kansas in 2015; and

WHEREAS, seven Tiger gridiron greats earned First Team All-American Athletic Conference (AAC) honors, and three received Third Team All-AAC nods; the seven first-team honorees are the most for Memphis since joining the AAC in 2013, while the ten total honorees are the most for the Tigers since the 2019 season; and

WHEREAS, UM quarterback Seth Henigan eclipsed 14,000 career passing yards in the team's 42-37 win over West Virginia in the Scooter's Coffee Frisco Bowl; he finished his collegiate career ranked thirteenth in NCAA history with 14,266 yards; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan broke a longstanding UM record in the team's 33-28 win over Charlotte when he threw a twenty-four-yard touchdown pass to wide receiver Roc Taylor with thirty-one seconds left in the game to put the Tigers in the lead and seal the victory; his ninety-first career passing touchdown surpassed Brady White's total for the most touchdown passes ever by a Tiger; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan threw his 104th career touchdown pass to Clayton Tune versus Houston to tie the AAC's career record; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan secured his rightful place in Memphis football history as the program's all-time leader in passing yards, passing touchdowns, and completion percentage; all four of his collegiate season performances fall in the top ten single-season passing yard totals in Tiger history, ranking third with 3,883 in 2023, sixth with 3,571 in 2022, seventh with 3,502 in 2024, and ninth with 3,322 in 2021; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan was named the Offensive Most Valuable Player (MVP) of the 2024 Scooter's Coffee Frisco Bowl, while his teammate Chandler Martin was named Defensive MVP; their selections marked the second consecutive year that both Mr. Henigan and Mr. Martin were named bowl game MVPs, having received the same honors in the 2023 AutoZone Liberty Bowl; and

WHEREAS, after receiving an invitation to the Reese's Senior Bowl, Seth Henigan ended the game 12-of-14 for 132 yards and a touchdown and captured the MVP title of the American Team; and

WHEREAS, UM running back Mario Anderson, Jr., and linebacker Chandler Martin earned All-America honors from *Phil Steele* and an honorable mention for their performance during the season; and

WHEREAS, Mario Anderson, Jr., finished his season ranked eighth in the nation with 1,674 total scrimmage yards and twenty-one total touchdowns; he had one of the most productive seasons for a Tiger running back, totaling 1,362 yards on the ground while rushing for eighteen touchdowns; and

WHEREAS, with 111 tackles, Chandler Martin ranked twenty-ninth in the Football Bowl Subdivision, and his sixteen tackles for loss ranked top fifteen nationally; and

WHEREAS, the members of the University of Memphis Tigers have truly distinguished themselves as gridiron greats, and they are richly deserving of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the coaches and players of the University of Memphis Tigers football team on an outstanding season and wish them much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.